# British Consolidate Gilgit

In early 1943, the British posted a Pushto-speaking Indian Army officer, Capt. William Brown, to the Gilgit Agency, where he spent the next three years. Brown had learnt Pushto at Peshawar while serving with the south Waziristan Scouts during 1942-43. He was appointed as the Assistant Political Agent for Chilas, which is only 90 km from Gilgit. Brown travelled widely throughout the Gilgit Agency, gaining experience and invaluable local knowledge. While in the Gilgit Agency, he learnt Shina, the dialect of the region, as well as some Burushaski, the language of Hunza. In 1946, he was posted to the Tochi Scouts in north Waziristan. In June 1947, he was posted to Chitral as the Acting Commandant of the Chitral Scouts.

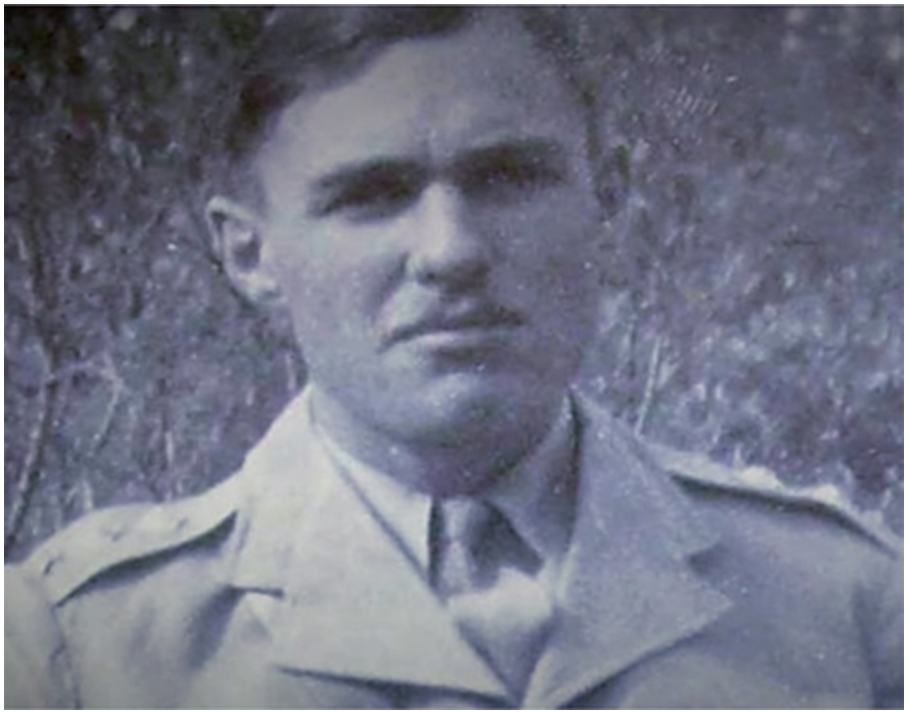


**Image 2.4:** Captain William Brown, Acting Commandant of the Gilgit Scouts
*Source: Public Domain*

Brown soon became an expert in the language, culture and politics of this region. Though he worked as an undercover army officer, he was clearly